

POINTING DEVICES

Rodent-like devices that have been around for a number of years have gone through a countless number of improvements. Comfort, utility and design are the key issues tackled by peripheral device makers. More recently, sensitivity has been the primary concern as the need for a more responsive and fluid means of 'pointing' have been in greater demand. Whether you are a gamer, a designer or a casual user, there is a mouse specifically designed for your hand.

From its inception, the pointing device has aimed to be an extension of one's hands. Not too far from now, we might just have to take that statement literally. Research is underway to create a device that senses eyeball movements to track the pointer. Such an innovation will virtually eliminate any physical intervention at all, not to mention that dastardly condition called Carpel Tunnel Syndrome. If you feel sensing eye movements is a bit too obtrusive, you might want to use a pointing device that fits like a glove. All of this nifty technology is coming to you in the near future.



Logitech Cordless MouseMan Wheel

The mouse equivalent of a Swiss Army knife: with its contoured shape and soft-touch sides, the Cordless MouseMan Wheel provides easy scrolling from anywhere near your computer

This device is a great buy if price is not an issue. The mouse features good accuracy, nice grip and the freedom of not being tied down proves to be an added comfort. The scroll button, in conjunction with the bundled application software, makes this mouse highly configurable and very easy to use over a range of applications.

+ 'No wires' cordless technology
+ Very comfortable
Price: Rs 4,500
Contact: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: July 2001

Worthy Mentions

Microsoft Intellimouse Explorer

+ Very accurate optical sensor technology
+ Good build quality
Price: Rs 3,250
Contact: Mnemonic Systems
Phone: 022-8010871
Fax: 022-8051761
E-mail: mnemonic@vsnl.com
Reviewed in: July 2001

Logitech MouseMan Wheel Optical

+ Excellent packaging
+ Good customisation through MouseWare
Price: Rs 2,900
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260256-59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Reviewed in: July 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Microsoft Intellimouse Eye 1999: Logitech Trackman Marble FX 1998: Logitech Trackman Marble FX

PROCESSORS

If any one component has been particularly blessed this year, it's got to be the CPU. We have to thank both AMD and Intel for the hearty competition; if it were not for them, gigahertz computing could not have been a reality today. Each CPU maker has highlighted various techniques used in squeezing the most performance out of their designs. Shrinking the chip, optimising its architecture and packing in as many transistors as possible have pushed performance to its limits.

If you think CPUs are fast now, just wait and see what's in store for the future. In 2002, 64-bit processors from Intel and AMD will gain greater penetration into the market and chips available today will scale towards the 3 GHz barrier. New developments in technology have allowed the big players to announce their plans to achieve 10 GHz clock speeds in the next few years. Who ever knew supercomputers could fit on desktops?



Intel Pentium-4 2 GHz

Be it multimedia, professional video and imaging applications or just pure gaming, the Pentium 4, 2 GHz packs a mean punch

Sporting a new packaging and an even greater pin density (up to 478 pins from the original 423), this processor packs the punch needed for any type of application you might want to throw at it. With a 400 MHz effective bus speed, 256K of L2 cache, and with the support of the high-bandwidth RDRAM, it makes for some real fast performance, be it gaming, multimedia applications or bandwidth-hungry audio and video applications.

+ Trailblazing performance
Price: Rs 25,217
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-6347158/59

Fax: 022-6347156
E-mail: sandip@nebulatech.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

Worthy Mentions

Pentium 4-1.8 GHz

+ Very good performance in multimedia and gaming applications
+ Good choice, especially for audio and video editing
Price: Rs 12,000
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-6347158/9
Fax: 022-6347156
E-mail: sandip@nebulatech.com
Reviewed in: October 2001

AMD Athlon 14GHz

+ Impressive real world performance
+ Very good pricing
Price: Rs 8,450
Contact: Zeta Technologies
Phone: 022-4102288
Fax: 022-4102277
E-mail: tejas@zetaindia.com
Reviewed in: October 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Intel P-III 1 GHz 1999: NA 1998: NA